PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

OFFICE OF SCHOOL MODERNIZATION

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Date: June 3, 2025

To: PPS Board of Education

From: Stormy Shanks, Senior Director, Office of School Modernization

Subject: 2025 Bond Seismic Improvements Program – June 2025 Report

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BACKGROUND

In May, 2025, voters approved a general obligation bond to complete capital improvement projects for Portland Public Schools. On May 6, 2025, the Board passed Resolution 7109 - Urgent Need for Seismic Retrofitting of High-Risk School Buildings, and Resolution 7110 - Resolution to Affirm the Board of Education's Commitment to Track and Report Findings, Public Engagement and Recommendation of Seismic Upgrades through the School Facilities Improvement and Operations Committee.

The 2025 Bond planning documents identified $190 million of funding for Deferred Maintenance & Priority Scope. Resolution 7109 directed Staff to establish "a reserve fund necessary for emergency, system end-of-useful life replacement and unplanned projects to respond to imminent or risks to students or PPS personnel, assumed to be in the range of $100 million over the life of the bond." The resolution also requires that, "Beyond the funds needed for that reserve, there shall be a default presumption that the first and highest use of funds available to address critical repairs and improvements at middle and elementary schools is to mitigate the seismic deficiencies at the 8-10 schools assessed to pose the greatest risk of injury or death in a significant seismic event."

Resolution 7110 identifies the SFIOC as the venue for bimonthly discussion and updates regarding the 2025 Bond Seismic Improvements Program to allow the opportunity to:

- To provide the public with regular updates on the progress of seismic upgrades;
- To provide a venue for district staff to present updates and recommendations for future work, for community members to provide feedback, and for school-based staff to have the opportunity to help inform priorities and recommendations;
- To provide consistent overview of seismic upgrades and other potential facilities upgrades such as HVAC, roofs, plumbing, and deferred maintenance, so that the board and public can understand the scope as well as potential trade-offs;
- To ensure that limited bond funds are maximized and the distribution of work done equitably, taking into account factors including but not limited to the condition of buildings, costs to remediate, enrollment, building utilization, and neighborhood demographics;
- To provide a venue for the discussion, analysis, and feedback of potential school enrollment or consolidations changes related to seismic plans;

- To provide a process for creating recommendations for the Board of Education.

CURRENT PHASE – PRIORITIZATION AND PLANNING

PPS is in the process of updating existing seismic conditions and project prioritization. This process is being accomplished in 3 steps:

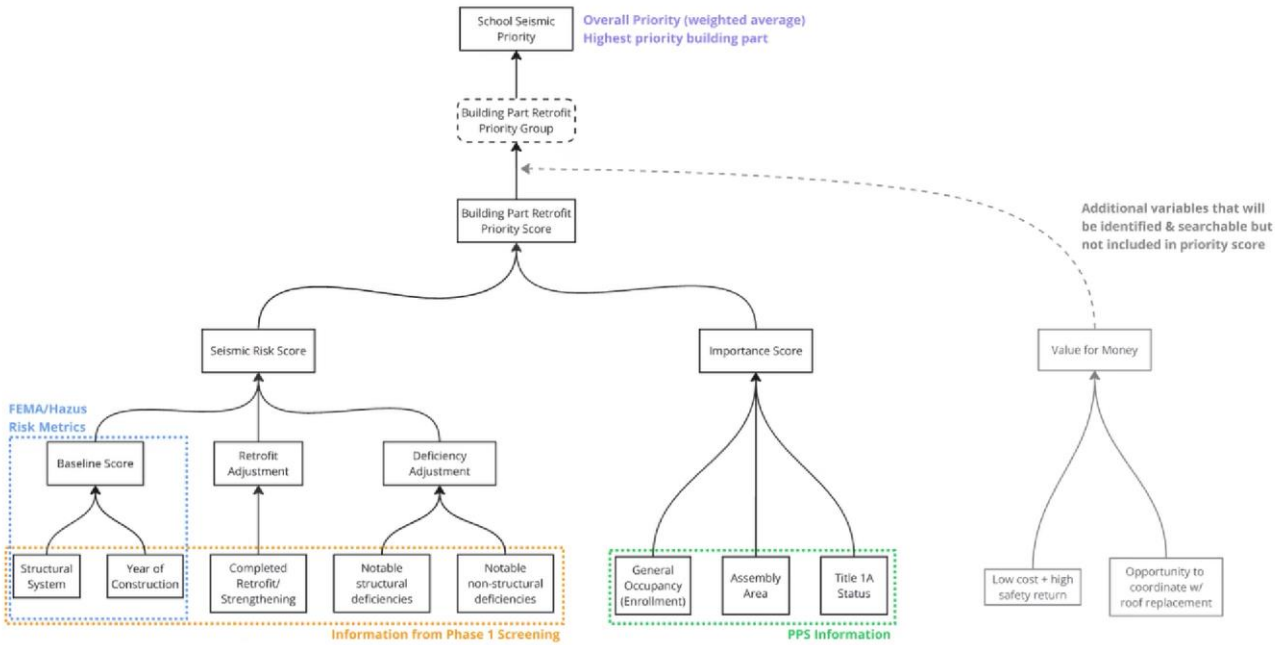
1. Gather detailed seismic deficiency data at all schools - Complete
2. Obtain priority recommendations from structural engineer - In Process
3. Evaluate recommendations Using PPS priority criteria - To Be Completed

1. Seismic Deficiency Data - Complete

In mid-2024, a structural engineering consultant delivered a high level seismic assessment report for all school buildings. The high level assessment report includes seismic vulnerabilities and rough order of magnitude (ROM) construction costs to correct the vulnerabilities.

2. Priority Recommendations - In Progress

At the end of 2024, a new contract was established with the engineering firm to develop a prioritization of the identified seismic work documented in the 2024 assessment. The prioritization work includes collaborating with the District to define the criteria by which the work is prioritized, completing the prioritization, and developing a report as the work product for the prioritization effort. Some of the prioritization criteria are technical in nature and are calculated according to FEMA and American Society of Structural Engineers (ASCE) standards. Other criteria are defined or informed by the district: building enrollment, space type affected by the deficiency, and Title I status, for example. OSM Staff are collaborating with the structural engineering consultant to establish criteria that reflect the District's values and determine how much weight is assigned to each criterion. Currently, the report is anticipated to be finalized this summer. This is a significant step in the process for prioritizing our seismic retrofit scope in a way that is intentional and based on accepted industry standards. A DRAFT version of the prioritization algorithm is below.



3. PPS Priority Criteria - To Be Completed

The final and critical step for PPS will be to review the engineers' recommendations and apply its own priorities and criteria to determine which projects should move forward. While the recommendations from phases one and two will provide a strong data-driven foundation, PPS will need to consider additional factors outside the engineers' scope. These include anticipated impacts of potential school consolidation, the feasibility and consequences of multi-summer construction schedules, and potential disruptions to ongoing programs such as summer school. This internal evaluation will ensure that Project decisions align with both operational realities and district-wide educational goals.

NEXT PHASE – EXECUTION PHASE

In the execution phase, OSM will execute the prioritized seismic improvement projects according to its Standard Operating Procedures for bond-funded construction programs. OSM will establish key performance indicators (KPIs) related to the Seismic program. Accountability and transparency will be provided through the following:

- OSM will report the status of the Seismic Upgrade Program bimonthly to the SFIOC in a dashboard style report that communicates the status of the scope, schedule, and budget for each identified project.
- OSM will also report the status of the program to the Bond Accountability Committee.
- A 2025 Bond Seismic Improvements website will provide updates to the public.
- The Seismic Improvements Program will be included in the annual performance audits that will cover the 2025 Bond as a whole.